Disadvantages:

1. This disinfectants does not destroy the spores.
2. Some disinfectants are injurious to the skin and articles.

Important points to remember:

- They should be used in correct strength.
- The articles should be fully submerged in it.
- They should be placed for a sufficient length of time.
- They should not be injurious to the skin and articles.
- The article should be thoroughly cleaned to remove the organic material.

Fumigation or gas sterilization:

The agents that are commonly used for fumigation are formalin tablets and ethylene oxide liquids. The exposure will destroy all types of bacteria, Viruses and most of the spores. The best results can be obtained with high concentration of gas and humidity.

Disadvantages

The smell of formaldehyde is irritant to the eyes, skin and mucus membrane.

5.2.3 Irradiation

IV) URAVIOLET LIGHT STERILIZATION:

Ultraviolet sterilization is effective for disinfecting working surfaces.

Disadvantages:

1. Bacteria in shadows are unaffected.
2. It does not penetrate.
3. Prolonged exposure to the ultraviolet rays causes conjunctiva damage and also injurious to the skin and tissues.
4. It is expensive.

5.3 Preparing articles for sterilization

1. The articles should be carefully arranged so that those needed first are on top.
2. They must be loosely packed for steam to penetrate.
3. Drums must the perforations opened.
4. Bundles should have a double wrapper.
5. For proper sterilization of instrument it should be free from dried blood or discharge.
6. Rubber tubing should be cleaned with cold water then with hot and soapy water. The inside must be thoroughly clean.
7. Sharp instruments, knives and needles should be dealt with separately to avoid cuts and puncture.

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